

Mehmet Kutluay

LEAD DATA SCIENTIST

Rotterdam - The Netherlands

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Skills

DATA SCIENCE

- Network Analytics, Anomaly Detection, Spark, Time Series Forecasting, Cross-Sectional Prediction, Data Visualization, ETL, Remote Sensing

SYNTAX AND PROGRAMMING

- Statistics/Data Science: Python, R, SQL, Matlab
- Engineering: Bash, Docker, Terraform
- Other: Markdown, Microsoft Office

LANGUAGES

- Turkish: Native
- English: Fluent, Business Proficient
- Dutch: Fluent, Business Proficient

Experience

Zanders

DATA SCIENCE MANAGER

April 2026 - Present

Utrecht

- Building up Zanders' capabilities in applying machine learning and Gen AI in financial institutions.

Sam Media

HEAD OF DATA

September 2025 - April 2026

Amsterdam

- Lead the central Data Team of 4-5 FTE's consisting of data analysts and data engineers.
- Envisioned, developed and executed product-based data strategy.
- Re-established Data Team's position within the company by re-building stakeholder relationships and deploying smarter reporting tools.
- Provided soft skills mentorship and guidance to team members.

Knab

LEAD DATA SCIENTIST

August 2023 - July 2025

Amsterdam

- Initially joined as senior data scientist, worked as lead data scientist from March 2024.
- Lead and mentored a team of 6-7 data scientists, while also working on model development and deployment.
- Deployed first ML models for the bank, initially in the transaction monitoring domain.
- Set up and developed the governance and technical framework for deploying more ML models. Established working relationships of data science with relevant teams (data engineering, data governance, business stakeholders and model risk management).
- Designed and executed the ML / AI strategy of Knab.

Apollo Agriculture

SENIOR DATA SCIENTIST

May 2022 - April 2023

Amsterdam

- Worked in a team of 4-5 data scientists, across multiple projects with different stakeholders. Projects entailed fraud detection, credit risk scoring and satellite image database creation.
- Launched and monitored multiple models in production. Deployments involved both batch processes and real-time applications.
- Set up the data science way-of-working (Docker for local development, coding standards, created/maintained Python microservices and more).
- Optimized and strengthened existing models by incorporating unit / integration tests and documentation for ease of onboarding.

Transactie Monitoring Nederland

SENIOR DATA SCIENTIST

May 2021 - April 2022

Purmerend

- Worked in a multifunctional department that consisted of data scientists and anti-money laundering experts.
- Created/maintained two Python packages for network analytics projects: 1. efficient network traversals and 2. detecting communities within networks. Both generated sample alerts later sent to shareholder banks.
- Main contact with engineering teams to ensure a workable framework for model development. Actively helped with setting up a feature store and enforcing Spark best practices.
- Integrated anti-money laundering experts actively into advanced analytics projects.
- Participated in high-level discussions on day-to-day and strategic topics for TMNL's anti-money laundering models.

ING Bank N.V. - Financial Crime Analytics

Nov 2019 - April 2021

DATA SCIENTIST

Amsterdam

- Worked in the global team of data scientists that developed models to detect money laundering and other financial economic crimes.
- Lead technical validation of machine learning transaction monitoring models in ING Turkey.
- Created/maintained two Python packages for: 1. streamlined unsupervised anomaly detection and 2. extracting network features from transaction data.
- Machine learning domain focus: unsupervised anomaly detection (e.g. isolation forest, k-means clustering, outlier variational autoencoder).
- Organized and ran workshops on day-to-day usage of Docker.
- Coached trainees to become data scientists.

ING Bank N.V. - Finance Analytics

Feb 2018 - Oct 2019

DATA SCIENTIST

Amsterdam

- Worked in a team of 2-3 data scientists that supported employees in Group Finance. All projects were centered around time series data cleaning, wrangling and forecasting.
- Created three R packages for time series forecasting, detecting/correcting anomalies and data exploration. These R packages are open sourced and maintained by me. Click for `tstools`, `tsclean`, `tsforecast`
- Machine learning domain focus: time series forecasting (ARIMA, LSTM, Kalman filter).
- Deployed projects via remote and Docker solutions.
- Organized and ran workshops in R, Python and statistics.
- Coached trainees to become data scientists.
- Engaged stakeholders to help them become more data-savvy and understand what they can do effectively with data science.

VU University Amsterdam

Sep 2014 - Aug 2018

PHD RESEARCHER IN ENVIRONMENTAL ECONOMICS

Amsterdam

- Introduced R as a syntax to replace licensed software (Stata) for doing statistical analyses within department.
- Organized and executed a field survey in Mumbai, India between March - June 2016. Trained a team of five surveyors and surveyed above 1500 residents.

VU University Amsterdam / Tinbergen Institute

Sep 2013 - Feb 2018

TEACHING ASSISTANT

Amsterdam

- Courses: Statistics/Econometrics (masters level - including coding in SPSS and R), Mathematics (masters level - linear algebra and advanced calculus)

Education

Amsterdam, The Netherlands

Sep 2014 - May 2019

PHD IN ECONOMICS

VU University Amsterdam

- Specialization: Applied micro-econometrics, environmental economics
- Thesis title: 'The Value of (Avoiding) Malaria' (https://www.dropbox.com/s/0du7immzy1k14o1/PhD_Thesis.pdf?dl=0)
- Supervisors: Roy Brouwer & Richard Tol
- Links to completed papers:
 - Valuing malaria morbidity (<https://www.tandfonline.com/doi/full/10.1080/21606544.2019.1581094>)
 - Preference updating in public health risk valuation (https://www.researchgate.net/publication/320234394_Preference_updating_in_public_he)
 - Public preferences and valuation of new malaria risk (https://www.researchgate.net/publication/320234398_Public_preferences_and_valuation)
 - Attitudes towards public health spending (<https://www.sussex.ac.uk/webteam/gateway/file.php?name=wps-07-2019.pdf&site=24>)
- This was financed by an EU FP7 project: HELIX (<https://www.helixclimate.eu/>). This involved multidisciplinary collaboration with researchers from mathematics, physics, engineering, geography and sociology.

Amsterdam/Rotterdam, The Netherlands

Sep 2012 - Aug 2014

MPHIL IN ECONOMICS

Tinbergen Institute

- Specialization: Applied micro-econometrics
- Thesis: 'What explains willingness to pay for avoiding morbidity risk due to malaria? Results from a global meta-analysis' (later on became first chapter of PhD thesis)

Ankara, Turkey

Sep 2008 - Jun 2012

BSC IN ECONOMICS

Bilkent University

- Specialization: Academic (i.e. a special focus on applied mathematics and statistics)